

OPD Appointment Scheduling Policy

Outpatient Department

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Department: Outpatient Department

Status: Active

1. Purpose

Defines how patients can book, reschedule, or cancel OPD appointments, and the policy applied to missed appointments.

2. Booking Channels

- Hospital helpline / call center
- Front-desk booking at the OPD reception
- Online patient portal / mobile app
- Direct referral from another department or consultant

3. Booking Requirements

Patients must provide their MR number (or full name and CNIC for new patients), preferred consultant or specialty, and preferred date/time. Confirmation is sent via SMS with the appointment time and token number.

4. Rescheduling Policy

Appointments can be rescheduled free of charge up to 2 hours before the scheduled time through any booking channel. Same-day rescheduling is subject to slot availability.

5. Cancellation Policy

Cancellations made more than 24 hours in advance are not charged. Cancellations within 24 hours may forfeit any advance booking fee, as per the consultant's individual policy.

6. No-Show Policy

A patient who does not arrive within 15 minutes of their allotted slot without prior notice is marked as a no-show; their token is released to the walk-in queue. Three consecutive no-shows require the patient to book only through the front desk for their next visit.

7. Priority Rebooking

Patients whose appointments are cancelled by the hospital (e.g., consultant unavailability) are given first priority for the next available slot at no additional cost.